Mikayel Tovmasyan

Public Economics Chair
WFI – Ingolstadt School of Management
Catholic University of Eichstätt-Ingolstadt, Germany

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Research and Teaching Fields

Research	Public Economics; International Economics; Political Economics; Applied Microeconomics
Teaching	Microeconomics and Macroeconomics; Public Economics; Causal Inference and Policy Evaluation; Econometrics; Mathematics and Statistics for Social Scientists and Economists

Job-market paper: *Bypassing Sanctions: Hide 'N Seek in Tax Havens*
Revise and resubmit, *Journal of International Economics*.

Education

04/2022–present	**Doctoral candidate in Economics** Catholic University of Eichstätt-Ingolstadt (KU), Germany Expected completion: June 2027 Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Dominika Langenmayr
2018–2021	**M.Sc. Economics, research track** University of Bayreuth, Germany Thesis: *Climate-related natural disasters, economic growth and civil conflict: A causal machine learning approach* Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Mario Larch; degree grade: 1.6 (1 best; 5 worst)
2009–2010	**M.Sc. Economics** London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE), UK Thesis: *Convergence across the U.S. States* Supervisor: Timothy Besley; grade: Merit
1997–2001	**B.Sc. Economics**, Highest Honors (Red Diploma) Yerevan State University, Armenia

Academic Appointments and Research Visits

04/2022–present	**Research Associate** Public Economics Chair, WFI – Ingolstadt School of Management, Catholic University of Eichstätt-Ingolstadt Fixed-term appointment through March 2027
01/2026–04/2026	**Visiting Researcher** International Tax Observatory, Paris School of Economics, France Invited by Gabriel Zucman
09/2023–02/2024	**Lecturer in Economics** (in German) Technische Hochschule Ingolstadt (THI)
04/2019–07/2019	**Teaching Associate in Econometrics** (in German) Chair of Empirical Economics, University of Bayreuth, Germany Undergraduate econometrics tutorials
2014–2018	**Full-time Lecturer in Economics** College of Business & Economics, American University of Armenia (AUA, affiliated with UC Berkeley) Economics teaching for undergraduate and graduate business and economics programs (in English)
12/2012–06/2014	**Adjunct Lecturer in Business Mathematics** International Center for Agribusiness Research and Education (ICARE, affiliated with Texas A&M University), Yerevan, Armenia Master of Agribusiness program (in English)

Teaching Experience

Undergraduate courses

	Course teaching
Lectures & tutorials	Political Economy, KU; Winter 2022/23, 2023/24, 2024/25, 2026/27 (in English)
Lectures & tutorials	Grundlagen der Mikro- und Makroökonomie (Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics), THI; Winter 2023/24 (in German)
Lectures & tutorials	Economics of Development, AUA; Fall 2016, 2017 (in English)
Lectures	Principles of Microeconomics, AUA; Spring 2014–2017 (in English)
Lectures	Principles of Macroeconomics, AUA; Spring 2015–2017 (in English)
Lectures & tutorials	Intermediate Macroeconomics, AUA; Fall 2016 (in English)
Lectures & tutorials	Economics of Sustainable Development, AUA; Spring 2016 (in English)
Lectures	Introduction to Economics, AUA; Fall 2015 (in English)
Lectures	Calculus for Business and Economics (developed and taught the course), AUA; Spring 2015 (in English)
	Tutorial teaching
Tutorials	Einführung in die VWL (Introduction to Economics), KU; Winter 2023/24 (in German)
Tutorials	Decision Theory, KU; Summer 2022, 2023 (in English)
Tutorials	Empirische Wirtschaftsforschung I (Econometrics), Bayreuth; Summer 2019 (in German)

Master's courses

	Course teaching
Seminar	Current Issues in Tax Policy, KU; Winter 2022/23–2026/27 (in English)
Lectures	Quantitative Methods for Economists, AUA; Spring 2014–2017 (in English)
Lectures	Mathematics for Economics and Business, ICARE; Fall 2012–2013 (in English)
	Tutorial teaching
Tutorials	Tax Policy, KU; Summer 2022–2026 (in English)
Tutorials	Tax Research, KU; Summer 2022–2026 (in English)

Teaching Awards and Evaluations

	Consistently excellent student evaluations of teaching (available upon request)
2015	**Faculty Teaching Excellence Award** (with a $1,000 prize), AUA

Thesis Supervision and Student Advising

2022–2026	Master's thesis supervision, KU 4 completed master's theses
2015–2018	Faculty Advisor to the Graduate Student Council, AUA

Course Coordination

2022–2026	**Lecture Series Sustainable Economy**, KU Ringvorlesung Nachhaltige Wirtschaft (undergraduate, in German) Coordinated planning and administration; attended weekly sessions and provided technical and other support for rotating guest lecturers

Research

Job-Market Paper

Bypassing Sanctions: Hide 'N Seek in Tax Havens download
(with Dominika Langenmayr and Sebastian Vosseler)
Revise and resubmit, *Journal of International Economics*

Do financial sanctions induce targets to move assets beyond the sanctioning country's reach? We combine quarterly BIS data on bilateral bank deposits with U.S. and EU financial sanctions from 1996–2023 and exploit variation in sanction timing across countries. Individual sanctions increase deposits in tax havens: by about 18% after U.S. sanctions and 46% after EU sanctions. Deposits simultaneously fall in sanctioning jurisdictions, especially after EU sanctions. When sanctions are more severe because the U.S. and EU sanction jointly, haven deposits do not increase on average; deposits in other foreign countries fall and domestic deposits rise. Major sanctions likewise restrict foreign deposits more broadly. Combining leaked offshore data with individual-level sanctions, we find that sanctioned individuals rely on existing shell companies, while other residents establish new offshore structures, potentially anticipating further sanctions.

Other Working Papers

Elections and Offshore Deposits: Evidence from Close Electoral Turnovers
(with Sebastian Vosseler)

We examine whether electoral turnovers affect offshore bank deposits, considering competing channels involving accountability, enforcement expectations and political uncertainty. The analysis combines quarterly bilateral BIS foreign bank deposit & offshore leaks data, with regression discontinuity and difference-in-differences designs.

The Education Gambit: Chess, Cognitive Skills, and a Natural Experiment in Armenia

I investigate whether Armenia's compulsory primary-school chess program affects students' cognitive performance in the school and long-term participation in competitive chess. The analysis combines adjacent-grade difference-in-differences & triple-differences designs using mathematics and language contest data with cohort comparisons and synthetic-control analysis of competitive-chess records.

Work in Progress

Film Publicity and the Allocation of Biodiversity Contributions

I study whether film publicity changes the allocation of voluntary contributions to biodiversity information—a public resource whose provision depends on private decisions. Using weekly counts of crowdsourced, species-specific wildlife observations from *iNaturalist* and a seasonal difference-in-differences design, I compare records concerning rabbits and hares with those concerning a fixed group of other animals around the 2018 U.S. release of *Peter Rabbit*.

Does Rent Control Increase Crime? Evidence from Germany
(with Seraphin Schwarzbauer)

We investigate whether housing-market regulation has broader social consequences beyond rents, focusing on the effects of Germany's rent regulation for new tenancies (*Mietpreisbremse*) on crime. Using municipality-level police-recorded crime data, we compare designated and non-designated areas before and after the reform, examining outcomes such as burglary, assault, and domestic violence, as well as differences by pre-reform rental exposure and housing conditions.

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2026	German Economic Association Annual Conference, Innsbruck; Armenian Economic Association Annual Meetings, Yerevan; International Tax Observatory, Paris School of Economics
2025	International Institute of Public Finance (IIPF) Annual Conference, Nairobi; Bavarian PhD Workshop in Development Economics, FAU Erlangen-Nürnberg; Armenian Economic Association Annual Meetings, Yerevan
2024	Public Finance Research Seminar (ifo/LMU), Munich; ZEW Public Finance Conference, Mannheim
2023	Public Finance Research Seminar (ifo/LMU), Munich; Armenian Economic Association Annual Meetings, Yerevan

Doctoral training

2026	Paris School of Economics Geolocalized Datasets and Applications for Economics
2022–2024	Bavarian Graduate Program in Economics (BGPE) Advanced Econometrics; Causal Effects in Applied Economics; Machine Learning for Economists; Advanced Macroeconomics; Empirical Labor Economics
2022–2023	KU doctoral program Research Agenda Management; Theoretical and Empirical Modeling

Academic Service

2025	Discussant, International Institute of Public Finance (IIPF) Annual Conference, Nairobi; Bavarian PhD Workshop in Development Economics, FAU Erlangen-Nürnberg
2024	Discussant, ZEW Public Finance Conference
2023	Discussant, Virtual Doctoral Tax Seminar, University of Mannheim
2014–2018	Served on the AUA Faculty Senate during the lecturer appointment

Scholarships and Research Funding

2026	Erasmus+ Staff Training Mobility Grant for a research stay at the International Tax Observatory, Paris School of Economics
2009	Luys Scholarship for M.Sc. Economics studies at LSE
1997–2001	Armenian Government Full Merit Scholarship for B.Sc. studies

Other Professional Experience

2012–2014	**Head of Economic Impact Assessment Unit** Guillotine (a regulatory reform project), Government Staff of the Republic of Armenia Assessed costs of tax legislation; managed a five-person impact assessment team, coordinated its work with 15 reviewers, and trained new team members
2011–2012	**Private Tutor**, London Mathematics, statistics, and economics
2002–2009	**Tax Advisor** Prepared income-tax declarations for individuals and sole proprietors and planned tax strategies for small businesses

Languages and Software

Languages	English, German, Russian (near-native/C2); Armenian (native); French (basic/A2).
Software	Stata; R; LaTeX Basic knowledge: Python; MATLAB; ArcGIS

References

Prof. Dr. Dominika Langenmayr
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